

the best frame rates for the least amount of money emerges the winner. Yes there is fanboyism but as the greatest generals of war will tell you, even the fiercest loyalty is fickle. Brands try to take the reference designs to newer heights by implementing their own tweaks. These may be higher clock speeds (known as factory overclocked cards), better coolers and PCB materials. This time around, general opinion is that NVIDIA pwned AMD in price ranges except when it came to dual core flagship chipsets from either of the vendors. At that pinnacle of performance, the winner was undecided.

This war between the chipset makers is waged in the background. To the consumer what comes next and what is perhaps a more important decision is which vendor to choose. Here too there are perceptions and fixed loyalties. Connoisseurs of GPUs, who regularly go in for cards (once every year in some cases) have intimate knowledge (from experience) about which brand has better service, which one has desired models easily available etc.

This year the most trusted brand for GPUs was ASUS garnering a score of 79.73 per cent. ASUS has been giving a firm push to both their marketing and distribution side throughout the year. Unlike other brands, ASUS specifically

targets enthusiasts through forums and other power user groups online. Besides, their presence in other categories such as Motherboards and Notebooks helps garner more trust and recall. The leader on our Trust Index was followed by MSI but with a distant score of 61.67 per cent while Zotac came in at the third spot with 59.05 per cent.

## Key findings:

When asked the first brand that comes to mind when thinking of GPUs, our respondents had some interesting answers. 21.8 percent of the respondents thought of NVIDIA and not a particular vendor brand. Correspondingly AMD garnered only 5.27 per cent recall.

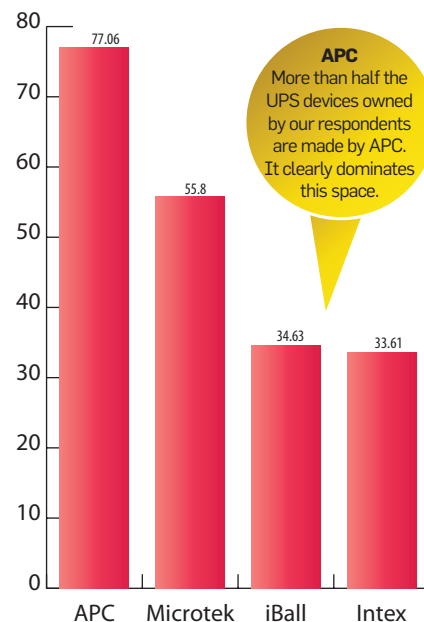
1. ASUS, MSI, and ZOTAC (in that order) are the leaders when it comes to after sales service. The three brands seem to have their customer care, RMA logistics etc properly in place.
2. XFX is the second most purchased brand and it isn't very far behind ASUS. 17.76 percent of our respondents owned ASUS cards while 15.79 percent owned XFX cards.
3. HIS and Leadtek had the least amount of aided recall. With only 3.75 and 3.06 per cent of the people having heard of them.



Frequent power cuts, load shedding, and voltage fluctuations are things we curse but they are conducive for the UPS business. According to most reports volume-wise, the industry grew by 20 per cent over the previous year. The most common type of UPS that we see is the online type of UPS. Apart from individual consumers, these devices are in demand at educational institu-

tions, government offices and corporate establishment.

In a home setup popular brands include APC, Microtek, iBall, Intex, Numeric etc. But which one is the most trusted? As per our Icons of Trust survey APC emerged at the top with 77.06 per cent score on our Trust Index. An interesting point to note is that the margin by which the number one brand is ahead of the second is the highest compared to any category. The second spot on the Trust Index was occupied by Microtek with a score of 55.8. That's a difference of 22 points. From the third spot to the seventh on the trust index, the scores were fairly evenly distributed i.e between 29 and 35.



## Ching's Secret

Instant, Hakka & Pad Thai Noodles,  
Soups, Sauces & Miracle Masala  
Ching's Khao, Baki Bhool Jao